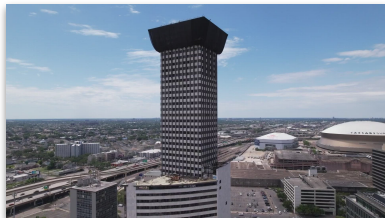




BlightWatch NOLA

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Introduction



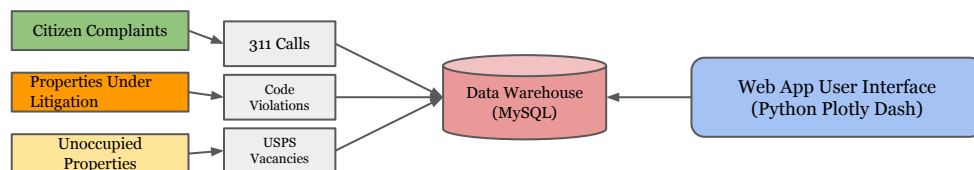
Blighted properties are buildings and lots that have been abandoned by their owner and left to decay. In New Orleans, blighted properties are pervasive² and represent an ongoing threat to the economy, health, and safety of the city.

Problem Statement



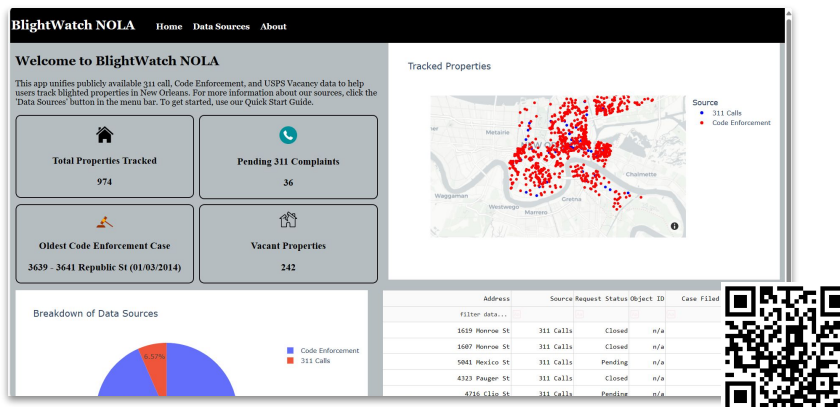
The city would benefit from a dedicated tool that stores and displays blighted property data. However, previous projects have been deprecated, and existing sites use incomplete datasets and are difficult to use.

Methods/Approach



Our team created a new data web app that unifies three data sources, stores them in a central database, and connects to a user-friendly front-end for analysis. Our database and front-end are hosted with PythonAnywhere.

Results



Our data web app, which includes a map displaying the location of properties and a table with additional information about each. Scan the QR code to try it yourself.

Lessons and Future Work



Our work is a positive step for increasing access and visibility of blight in New Orleans. Some challenges we've experienced were extracting coordinates and zip codes from addresses, as well as learning a new front-end framework, Dash.

The room for expansion includes creating predictive analytics which could be used to predict areas at risk for blight, as well as incorporating property market data to identify properties for rehabilitation and investment. We hope that future teams will expand on this project to create a lasting resource for the city.



References

- ¹Apollitical. *New Orleans cuts blight by using data to predict official decisions.* (30 May 2017) <https://apolitical.co/solution-articles/en/new-orleans-cuts-blight-using-data-predict-official-decisions>
- ²Dolfman, Michael. *The effects of Hurricane Katrina on The New Orleans Economy.* (June 2007) <https://www.bls.gov/opub/mlr/2007/06/artfull.pdf>
- ³Poche, Snapper, Dylan Knaggs, Mike Flowers, and Brian Ableson. "Code Enforcement Abatement Tool." nola.gov, 2015. <https://nola.gov/performance-and-accountability/reports/nolalytics-reports/nolalytics-blight-abatement-tool-brief/>.